The nervous system 3a

A dictagloss activity

Note: Teacher instructions to ensure the success of this activity can be found in the answer section.

1 A dictagloss is similar to a dictation, but the text to be written is read much faster.

- The teacher, or another student, will read out Part A (below) to the class while you just listen.
- Part A is read aloud again and this time you can make some notes on the sheet provided.
- The text is read a third time while you improve your notes. In groups, make corrections and write the text out in sentences.
- The same text will then be read for the last time, while you compare and correct your writing.
- Repeat the dictagloss with Part B.

Part A

The nervous system allows living things to detect what is going on around them. This is called sensitivity. Any change which the nervous system detects is called a stimulus. The nervous system processes the information and then a gland or a muscle reacts. This reaction is called a response.

The nervous system is made up of the central nervous system and the peripheral nervous system. The central nervous system includes the brain and the spinal cord for many involuntary and automatic responses. The peripheral nervous system is a network of nerves that spread throughout the body. They connect the nerve endings in muscles, glands and sense organs to the central nervous system.

Part B

Nerves are made up of special cells called neurones. The bundles of neurones look like the wires in a telephone cable. These nerve cells carry electric impulses or messages at great speed around the body. There are three kinds of neurones: sensory neurones carry messages to the central nervous system; motor neurones carry messages from the brain; and connector neurones carry messages in the brain and spinal cord.

Neurones, or nerve cells, are quite strange looking cells. They have a long thin fibre stretching from a cell body. These fibres are called axons. The axons are covered by a myelin sheath for insulation and greater speed. Then there are short fibres coming off the cell body like skinny fingers. These dendrites pick up messages from other neurones nearby and then pass them along the axon.

Notes for Part A

Text for Part A

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The nervous system

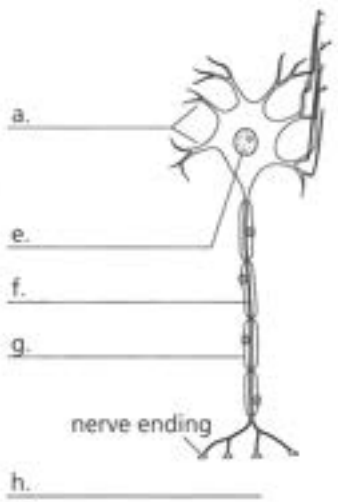
3b

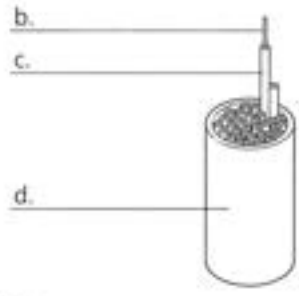
Notes for Part B

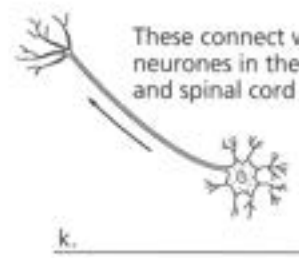
Text for Part B

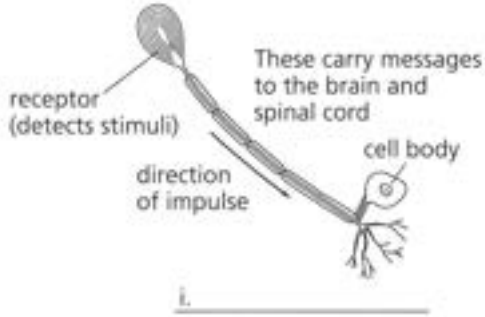
2 Use the information from your dictagloss to label each of these diagrams. Choose the labels from the words in the box.

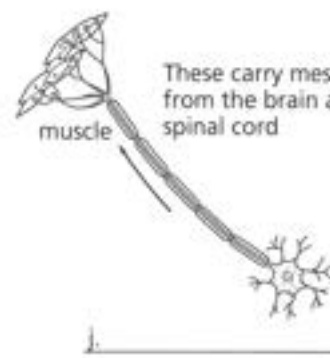
axon	dendrites	myelin sheath	nerve	nerve cell	neurone
sensory neurone	nucleus	axon	motor neurone	connector neurone	











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